

# FIFA World Cup

The FIFA World Cup began in Uruguay in 1930. It was not played in 1942 or 1946 because of the Second World War and its aftermath. The competition expanded over time from 13 teams in 1930 to 48 teams in 2026.

## FIFA World Cup editions, 1930 onward

| Year | Host(s)                          | Teams | Winner           | Runner-up | Third       | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                          |
|------|----------------------------------|-------|------------------|-----------|-------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 2026 | Canada, Mexico and United States | 48    | <b>Spain</b>     | Argentina | England     | France                      | Spain 1-0 Argentina            |
| 2022 | Qatar                            | 32    | <b>Argentina</b> | France    | Croatia     | Morocco                     | Argentina 3-3 France; 4-2 pens |
| 2018 | Russia                           | 32    | <b>France</b>    | Croatia   | Belgium     | England                     | France 4-2 Croatia             |
| 2014 | Brazil                           | 32    | <b>Germany</b>   | Argentina | Netherlands | Brazil                      | Germany 1-0 Argentina (a.e.t.) |

| Year | Host(s)               | Teams | Winner              | Runner-up    | Third   | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                          |
|------|-----------------------|-------|---------------------|--------------|---------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 2010 | South Africa          | 32    | <b>Spain</b>        | Netherlands  | Germany | Uruguay                     | Spain 1-0 Netherlands (a.e.t.) |
| 2006 | Germany               | 32    | <b>Italy</b>        | France       | Germany | Portugal                    | Italy 1-1 France; 5-3 pens     |
| 2002 | South Korea and Japan | 32    | <b>Brazil</b>       | Germany      | Türkiye | South Korea                 | Brazil 2-0 Germany             |
| 1998 | France                | 32    | <b>France</b>       | Brazil       | Croatia | Netherlands                 | France 3-0 Brazil              |
| 1994 | United States         | 24    | <b>Brazil</b>       | Italy        | Sweden  | Bulgaria                    | Brazil 0-0 Italy; 3-2 pens     |
| 1990 | Italy                 | 24    | <b>West Germany</b> | Argentina    | Italy   | England                     | West Germany 1-0 Argentina     |
| 1986 | Mexico                | 24    | <b>Argentina</b>    | West Germany | France  | Belgium                     | Argentina 3-2 West Germany     |

| Year | Host(s)      | Teams | Winner       | Runner-up      | Third        | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                              |
|------|--------------|-------|--------------|----------------|--------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1982 | Spain        | 24    | Italy        | West Germany   | Poland       | France                      | Italy 3-1 West Germany             |
| 1978 | Argentina    | 16    | Argentina    | Netherlands    | Brazil       | Italy                       | Argentina 3-1 Netherlands (a.e.t.) |
| 1974 | West Germany | 16    | West Germany | Netherlands    | Poland       | Brazil                      | West Germany 2-1 Netherlands       |
| 1970 | Mexico       | 16    | Brazil       | Italy          | West Germany | Uruguay                     | Brazil 4-1 Italy                   |
| 1966 | England      | 16    | England      | West Germany   | Portugal     | Soviet Union                | England 4-2 West Germany (a.e.t.)  |
| 1962 | Chile        | 16    | Brazil       | Czechoslovakia | Chile        | Yugoslavia                  | Brazil 3-1 Czechoslovakia          |

| Year | Host(s)     | Teams | Winner                  | Runner-up      | Third            | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                                           |
|------|-------------|-------|-------------------------|----------------|------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 1958 | Sweden      | 16    | <b>Brazil</b>           | Sweden         | France           | West Germany                | Brazil 5-2<br>Sweden                            |
| 1954 | Switzerland | 16    | <b>West<br/>Germany</b> | Hungary        | Austria          | Uruguay                     | West Germany<br>3-2 Hungary                     |
| 1950 | Brazil      | 13    | <b>Uruguay</b>          | Brazil         | Sweden           | Spain                       | Uruguay 2-1<br>Brazil (final-<br>group decider) |
| 1938 | France      | 15    | <b>Italy</b>            | Hungary        | Brazil           | Sweden                      | Italy 4-2<br>Hungary                            |
| 1934 | Italy       | 16    | <b>Italy</b>            | Czechoslovakia | Germany          | Austria                     | Italy 2-1<br>Czechoslovakia<br>(a.e.t.)         |
| 1930 | Uruguay     | 13    | <b>Uruguay</b>          | Argentina      | United<br>States | Yugoslavia                  | Uruguay 4-2<br>Argentina                        |

## Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

|                                                                                                                          |          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Brazil</b><br>                       | <b>5</b> |
| 1958, 1962, 1970, 1994, 2002                                                                                             |          |
| <b>Italy</b><br>                        | <b>4</b> |
| 1934, 1938, 1982, 2006                                                                                                   |          |
| <b>Germany (incl. West Germany)</b><br> | <b>4</b> |
| 1954, 1974, 1990, 2014                                                                                                   |          |
| <b>Argentina</b><br>                    | <b>3</b> |
| 1978, 1986, 2022                                                                                                         |          |
| <b>Uruguay</b><br>                      | <b>2</b> |
| 1930, 1950                                                                                                               |          |
| <b>France</b><br>                       | <b>2</b> |
| 1998, 2018                                                                                                               |          |
| <b>Spain</b><br>                      | <b>2</b> |
| 2010, 2026                                                                                                               |          |
| <b>England</b><br>                    | <b>1</b> |
| 1966                                                                                                                     |          |

### **Format milestones**

- **1930:** 13 teams played the first edition.
- **1950:** no single final was scheduled; the decisive final-group match between Uruguay and Brazil determined the champion.

- **1982:** the field expanded from 16 to 24 teams.
- **1998:** the field expanded to 32 teams.
- **2026:** the field expanded to 48 teams and was hosted by three countries for the first time.

## **Memorable moments**

- Uruguay defeated Brazil in the decisive 1950 match at the Maracanã, a result remembered as the *Maracanazo*.
- Brazil's 1970 side became the first team to win three World Cups.
- Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.
- Croatia reached its first final in 2018.
- Argentina and France played a 3–3 final in 2022 before Argentina won the shoot-out.
- Spain won its second title in 2026.

## **Editorial notes**

- The 1930 tournament did not include a third-place match. FIFA's historical ranking places the United States third and Yugoslavia fourth.
- The 1950 final positions came from a four-team final group rather than semifinals and a final.
- “Germany” totals conventionally include West Germany's results.

## **References & review**

**Status:** review

Last reviewed: 23 July 2026

- FIFA tournament history and champions (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>).
- FIFA tournament history and champions (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain>).
- FIFA 2026 awards (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/award-winners>).

- **FIFA historical top scorers** (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/fontaine-mbappe-ronaldo-and-more-every-world-cup-top-scorer>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.